

# Huduma Platform

## User Guide

Multi-Category Service Marketplace for Kenya & East Africa

Version 1.0 • July 2025

Android • iOS • Web

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# 1. Introduction

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Huduma Platform is a multi-category service marketplace designed for Kenya and East Africa. It connects **service seekers** (people who need work done) with **service providers** (skilled professionals) across 19 service categories.

## What You Can Do

| Feature                | Description                                                                                 |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Find Service Providers | Browse verified professionals for house help, plumbing, electrical work, tutoring, and more |
| Post Jobs              | Create listings to hire someone for a specific task or ongoing work                         |
| Apply for Work         | Service providers can browse and apply to available jobs                                    |
| Communicate            | Message service providers or clients directly through in-app chat                           |
| Review & Rate          | Leave reviews after a job is completed to help others decide                                |

## Who Is It For?

| User Type                | Examples                                                               |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Service Seekers</b>   | Homeowners, tenants, families, businesses looking to hire              |
| <b>Service Providers</b> | House helps, plumbers, electricians, tutors, painters, mechanics, etc. |

## 2. Getting Started

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### System Requirements

| Platform | Minimum Version                                    |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Android  | Version 6.0 (Marshmallow) or higher                |
| iOS      | Version 13.0 or higher                             |
| Web      | Any modern browser (Chrome, Safari, Firefox, Edge) |

### Installation

- 1 Download the Huduma Platform app from the Google Play Store or Apple App Store.
- 2 Open the app after installation.
- 3 You will be taken to the **Onboarding** screen.

### 3. Authentication (Login & OTP)

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Huduma Platform uses **phone-number-based authentication** with OTP (One-Time Password) verification via SMS. No password is required.

#### Step 1: Onboarding

When you first open the app, you will see a three-page introduction:

**Page 1 — Find Trusted Services:** Learn about finding verified professionals near you.

**Page 2 — Housing Made Easy:** Discover rental and housing options.

**Page 3 — Verified & Reviewed:** Understand how reviews and verification work.

Swipe left/right to navigate between pages, then tap:

- **"Get Started"** — To create a new account.
- **"I already have an account"** — To sign in.

#### Step 2: Enter Your Phone Number

- 1 Your country code defaults to **Kenya (+254)**.

- 2 Enter your **10-digit phone number** (e.g., 0796XXXXXX).
- 3 Tap "**Continue**".

### Step 3: Verify OTP

- 1 A **6-digit verification code** will be sent to your phone via SMS.
- 2 Enter the code in the input field.
- 3 The code **auto-submits** when all 6 digits are entered.

**Tip:** If you did not receive the code, wait for the 60-second timer to expire, then tap "**Resend Code**". Ensure you have SMS reception.

**Note:** If this is your first time, you may be asked to set up your profile before proceeding.

## 4. Home Screen

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The Home Screen is your main dashboard after logging in.

### Screen Layout

| Section           | Description                                              |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Greeting Header   | Displays "Hello [Your Name]" with a personalized tagline |
| Notification Bell | Top-right icon with badge showing unread count           |
| Search Bar        | Tap to search for services, housing, or providers        |
| Quick Actions     | Three shortcut buttons for common tasks                  |
| Categories        | Horizontal scrollable list of service categories         |
| Recent Listings   | Latest service listings posted on the platform           |

### Quick Action Buttons

| Button            | What It Does                                      |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Post a Job</b> | Opens the Create Listing screen to post a new job |

|                     |                                                       |
|---------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Find Housing</b> | Filters listings to show rental/housing options       |
| <b>Hire Pro</b>     | Opens the full categories list to browse all services |

## Bottom Navigation Bar

| Tab                 | Description                                    |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Home</b>         | Main dashboard with listings and quick actions |
| <b>Categories</b>   | Browse all 19 service categories               |
| <b>Applications</b> | View jobs you've applied to                    |
| <b>Messages</b>     | Your conversations with other users            |
| <b>Profile</b>      | Your profile and settings                      |



## 5. Browsing Categories

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### How to Access

- Tap the **Categories** tab in the bottom navigation bar
- Tap **"See all"** next to Categories on the Home Screen
- Tap **"Hire Pro"** quick action button

### Category Cards

Each category is displayed as an elevated card with:

- A **colored icon** representing the service type
- The **category name** (e.g., "Plumber", "Electrician")
- A **teal pill badge** showing the number of active listings

Tap any category card to view all listings in that category.

# 6. Viewing Listings

Tap any listing to open its detail view.

## Listing Detail Screen

| Section         | Details                                              |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Image Gallery   | Swipeable images uploaded by the poster              |
| Title           | Job or service title                                 |
| Category Badge  | The category this listing belongs to                 |
| Budget          | Minimum and maximum budget range in KES, plus period |
| Location        | County or specific area                              |
| Engagement Type | One-time, ongoing, or contract                       |
| Description     | Full description of the job or service needed        |
| Provider Info   | Name and profile of the poster                       |
| Apply Button    | Button to submit your application                    |

# 7. Creating a Listing

## How to Create a Listing

- 1

Tap **"Post a Job"** on the Home Screen.
- 2

Fill in the listing form (see fields below).
- 3

Tap **"Create Listing"** to publish.
- 4

A success message appears and you return to the previous screen.

## Listing Form Fields

| Field        | Required | Description                                |
|--------------|----------|--------------------------------------------|
| Listing Type | Yes      | Choose "Hire Someone" or "Request Service" |
| Title        | Yes      | Descriptive title (minimum 10 characters)  |
| Category     | Yes      | Select from the dropdown of 19 categories  |
| Description  | Yes      | Detailed description (20–1,000 characters) |

|                 |    |                                         |
|-----------------|----|-----------------------------------------|
| Budget Min      | No | Minimum budget in KES                   |
| Budget Max      | No | Maximum budget in KES                   |
| Budget Period   | No | Monthly, weekly, daily, or one-time     |
| Location        | No | County or area where the work is needed |
| Engagement Type | No | One-time, ongoing, or contract          |

### Tips for a Good Listing:

- Use a clear, specific title (e.g., "Need experienced plumber for kitchen sink repair in Westlands").
- Write a detailed description including scope of work, requirements, and timeline.
- Set a realistic budget range to attract qualified providers.
- Specify the location to help providers assess commute distance.

## 8. Applying to a Listing

- 1 Open a listing and tap the **"Apply"** button.
- 2 Fill in the application form:

| Field         | Required | Description                                      |
|---------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Cover Message | No       | Brief message to the poster (max 500 characters) |
| Proposed Rate | No       | Your proposed rate in KES                        |

- 3 Tap **"Submit Application"** to send.
- 4 A confirmation message appears.

**Tips:** Write a personalized cover message highlighting your experience. Be responsive — check your messages after applying as the poster may reach out.

## 9. Managing Applications

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Tap the **Applications** tab in the bottom navigation bar to view all jobs you've applied to.

### Application Statuses

| Status    | Meaning                                                    |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pending   | Your application has been submitted and is awaiting review |
| Accepted  | The poster has accepted your application                   |
| Rejected  | The poster has declined your application                   |
| Withdrawn | You have withdrawn your application                        |

## 10. Messaging

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### Starting a Conversation

Conversations are initiated when a poster responds to your application, you are accepted for a job, or a user contacts you about a listing.

### Chat Features

| Feature             | Description                                          |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Real-time messaging | Messages are delivered instantly via WebSocket       |
| Message types       | Text messages and file attachments                   |
| Read receipts       | See when your message has been read                  |
| Mute                | Mute conversations you don't want notifications from |

### How to Use Chat

- 1 Tap the **Messages** tab in the bottom navigation bar.
- 2 Your conversations are listed with the most recent at the top.

- 3 Tap a conversation to open it.
- 4 Type your message and tap send.



# 11. Profile Management

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## Viewing Your Profile

Tap the **Profile** tab in the bottom navigation bar.

| Section            | Details                                       |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Avatar             | Your profile photo (or default icon)          |
| Full Name          | Your first and last name                      |
| Phone Number       | Your registered phone number                  |
| Verification Badge | Shown if your identity is verified            |
| Stats              | Rating, number of reviews, and jobs completed |
| Bio                | Your personal description                     |
| Location           | Your primary location                         |
| Member Since       | Date you joined the platform                  |

## Editing Your Profile

- 1

Tap the **pencil icon** (edit button) on the Profile screen.
- 2

Update the fields below.
- 3

Tap **"Save Changes"** to update.

| Field        | Required | Description                                      |
|--------------|----------|--------------------------------------------------|
| First Name   | Yes      | Your first name                                  |
| Last Name    | Yes      | Your last name                                   |
| Display Name | No       | A public display name                            |
| Gender       | No       | Male, Female, or Other                           |
| Bio          | No       | Short description about you (max 300 characters) |

Additional Profile Actions

| Action         | Description                                   |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Notifications  | View and manage your notification preferences |
| Help & Support | Access help resources and contact support     |
| Privacy Policy | Read the platform's privacy policy            |

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[Logout](#)

[Sign out of your account](#)

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## 12. Notifications

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Access notifications by tapping the **bell icon** on the Home Screen or from your Profile screen.

| Notification Type  | Description                                                             |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Application Update | When someone applies to your listing or your application status changes |
| New Message        | When you receive a new chat message                                     |
| Review Received    | When someone leaves a review on your profile                            |
| Listing Update     | Changes to listings you're involved with                                |
| System             | Platform announcements and updates                                      |

## 13. Reviews & Ratings

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### How Reviews Work

After a job is completed, both parties can leave reviews.

| Component | Description                           |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|
| Rating    | 1 to 5 stars                          |
| Comment   | Written feedback about the experience |

### Leaving a Review

- 1 Navigate to the completed listing.
- 2 Tap the review option.
- 3 Select a star rating (1–5).
- 4 Write an optional comment.
- 5 Submit your review.



**Note:** Reviews are permanent and cannot be edited or deleted. Please be honest and constructive.

## 14. Service Categories Reference

| #  | Category              | Typical Services                                      |
|----|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | House Help            | Live-in/out domestic worker, household management     |
| 2  | Babysitter / Nanny    | Childcare, school pick-up, after-school care          |
| 3  | Cleaning              | Deep cleaning, regular cleaning, move-in/out cleaning |
| 4  | Electrician           | Wiring, socket installation, circuit repairs          |
| 5  | Plumber               | Pipe repair, tap installation, drainage               |
| 6  | Carpenter             | Furniture making, door fitting, cabinet work          |
| 7  | Painter               | Interior/exterior painting, wallpaper                 |
| 8  | Mason                 | Concrete work, bricklaying, building construction     |
| 9  | Gardener / Landscaper | Lawn care, landscaping, tree trimming                 |
| 10 | Mechanic              | Engine repair, servicing, bodywork                    |
| 11 | Tutor                 | Math, science, languages, exam preparation            |
| 12 | Catering / Chef       | Event catering, personal chef, meal prep              |

|    |                     |                                          |
|----|---------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 13 | Laundry             | Washing, ironing, dry cleaning           |
| 14 | Security Guard      | Day/night security, event security       |
| 15 | Driver              | Personal driver, delivery, chauffeur     |
| 16 | Mover               | House moving, office relocation, packing |
| 17 | Tailor / Seamstress | Alterations, custom clothing, repairs    |
| 18 | Beautician / Barber | Haircuts, styling, beauty treatments     |
| 19 | General Handyman    | Multi-skill repairs and maintenance      |



## 15. Troubleshooting

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| Problem                   | Solution                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OTP not received          | Wait 60 seconds and tap "Resend Code". Check that your phone number is correct. Ensure you have SMS reception. |
| App won't load            | Check your internet connection. Try closing and reopening the app.                                             |
| Cannot submit application | Ensure you are logged in. Check that the listing is still active.                                              |
| Profile not updating      | Ensure all required fields (First Name, Last Name) are filled. Check your internet connection.                 |
| Messages not sending      | Check your internet connection. The app uses real-time WebSocket — a stable connection is required.            |
| Listing not appearing     | New listings may take a moment to appear. Pull down to refresh the listings page.                              |

**Need More Help?** Use the **Help & Support** option in your Profile screen to contact the support team.

# System Architecture Overview

| Component      | Technology            | Purpose                                         |
|----------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Mobile App     | Flutter (Dart)        | Cross-platform user interface                   |
| Backend API    | NestJS (TypeScript)   | Business logic, authentication, data management |
| Database       | PostgreSQL (Neon)     | Persistent data storage                         |
| Cache          | Redis (Upstash)       | Session management, OTP storage                 |
| Authentication | JWT + OTP via SMS     | Secure phone-based login                        |
| Real-time      | WebSocket (Socket.IO) | Instant messaging                               |
| SMS Provider   | Africa's Talking      | OTP delivery                                    |

## Key API Endpoints

| Endpoint          | Method | Description                  |
|-------------------|--------|------------------------------|
| /auth/otp/request | POST   | Request OTP for phone number |
| /auth/otp/verify  | POST   | Verify OTP and get JWT token |
| /auth/refresh     | POST   | Refresh expired JWT token    |

|                     |          |                             |
|---------------------|----------|-----------------------------|
| /profiles           | GET/PUT  | View or update profile      |
| /categories         | GET      | List all service categories |
| /listings           | GET/POST | Browse or create listings   |
| /applications       | GET/POST | View or submit applications |
| /reviews            | GET/POST | View or submit reviews      |
| /chat/conversations | GET      | List conversations          |
| /notifications      | GET      | View notifications          |

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